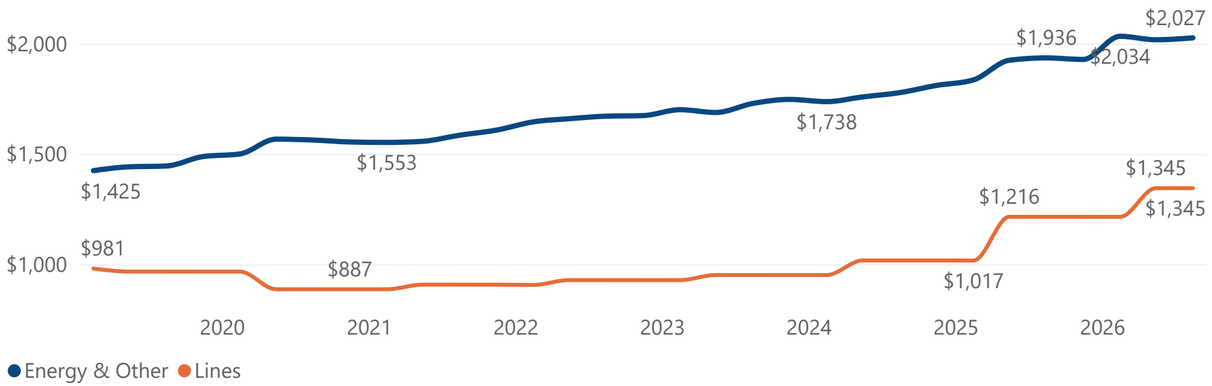
NZ Household Electricity Prices, 2019–2026

Q1: Power prices rose faster than inflation (Feb 2019 – Aug 2026)

Price now (c/kWh)	Power price rise since 2019	Inflation (CPI) since 2019	Real rise after inflation
42.15	40.2%	33.3%	5.1%

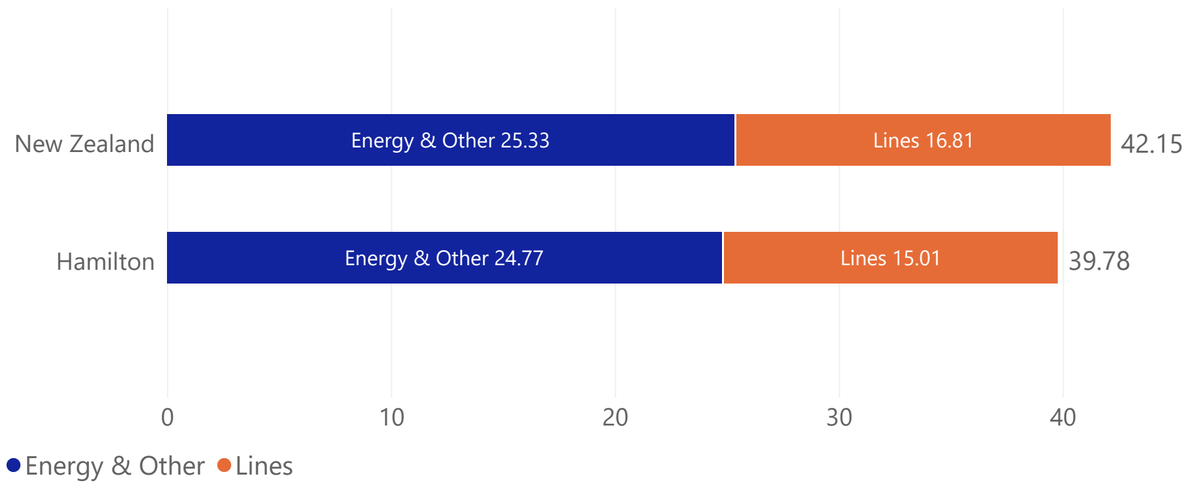
Q3: Lines charges were flat until 2024, then rose sharply

Yearly bill, typical NZ household (8,000 kWh)



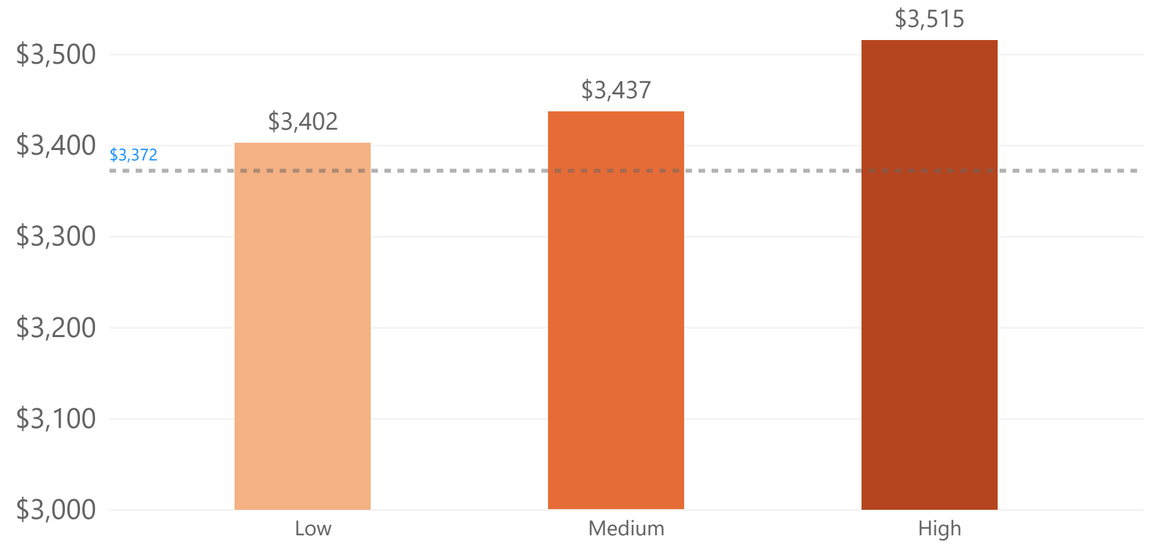
Q4: Hamilton pays less than the NZ average, mainly due to lower lines charges

Price per kWh (cents), Aug 2026



Q5: 2027 bills could rise by $31 to $143 a year (lines charges only)

Typical NZ household, 8,000 kWh, from April 2027 · scenarios, not forecasts



Key insights

- Power prices rose 40.2% since 2019, faster than inflation (33.3%), a 5.1% real rise.
- Lines charges were flat until 2024, then jumped ~40%.
- Hamilton pays 2.36c/kWh less than the NZ average, mainly due to lower lines charges.
- If lines charges keep rising, a typical bill could be $31–$143 higher in 2027.
- Q2: see the Towns page - Balclutha most expensive, Wellington City cheapest.

Source: *MBIE QSDEP (Aug 2026), Stats NZ CPI. Prices include GST; model household of 8,000 kWh/year.*

Q2: Power price by town (Aug 2026, c/kWh)

Balclutha is the most expensive; Wellington City the cheapest

